

PURITY FACTOR A worker feeds groundnut seeds into a mechanised mortar and pestle for extracting cooking oil at a cold press in Bengaluru

AFP

COOKING UP A STORM

INDIA IS IN A MISSION MODE TO RAISE ITS OILSEEDS PRODUCTION CAPACITY TO BE SELF-RELIANT IN THE EDIBLE OILS SECTOR

As India strides boldly into the realm of self-reliance in edible oils, it has to navigate a landscape of evolving policies and cutting-edge innovations to fortify its domestic edible oil production. Yet, amid this transformative journey, the import graph continues its upward trajectory. In July, India purchased a staggering 1.76 million tonnes of edible oils from global markets. In the first nine months of the 2022-23 oil year (November to October), there was a 23 per cent surge in the import of these vital cooking oils, from 9.98 MT to 12.3 MT in the same period the previous year.

In mid-June, the government reduced import duties on select edible oils, thus welcoming more foreign oils onto the Indian plate. Now, India accounts for 15 per cent of the world's edible oil imports, with a bill that touched Rs 1.57 lakh crore in the oil year ending October 2022.